

Branch Dashboard: KYC Work Returns Modernization

Modernizing a high-risk branch compliance workflow into a clearer, action-oriented experience for managers and bankers.

9.5/10 UMUX-Lite score	100% CSAT score	7 CX gaps closed
3 High-severity CX gaps closed	12 mo. End-to-end product effort	Enterprise Branch controls and compliance

Role: Lead Product Designer / UX Strategist / UI Designer

Focus: KYC work returns, branch controls, compliance visibility, issue resolution, and customer account protection.

Partners: Quad partners, business stakeholders, compliance and operations teams, end users, and cross-impacted business teams.

Note for portfolio use: screenshots and internal artifacts should be sanitized or recreated before publishing externally. This PDF is written as case study content that can be paired with approved visuals.

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1. Executive Summary

Branch Dashboard is a branch controls and compliance experience used to monitor operational risk, control tasks, and action items across branch locations. Within that ecosystem, KYC account opening and maintenance work returns were a high-friction workflow. When required customer or account information was missing or invalid, branch teams had to resolve the issue quickly to avoid customer account restrictions or closures.

I led the modernization of the KYC Work Returns experience over a 12-month effort. The work moved from discovery through delivery, including journey mapping, stakeholder collaboration, co-creation, feature prioritization, information architecture, high-fidelity design, usability testing, UI refinement, and accessibility deliverables.

The final experience shifted branch teams from a reactive, unclear workflow to a proactive, action-oriented dashboard. It increased urgency awareness, simplified navigation, surfaced trend data, and gave users clearer pathways to resolve issues before customer impact occurred.

Portfolio framing: This is not simply a dashboard redesign. It is an enterprise workflow modernization case study that demonstrates research rigor, cross-functional alignment, compliance domain expertise, and measurable UX outcomes.

2. Context and Business Problem

Branch Dashboard helps branch employees monitor controls and compliance metrics. It supports risk reduction by making operational issues visible to branch leaders and enabling them to act before issues become exceptions, missed audits, customer problems, or compliance escalations.

The KYC Work Returns modernization focused on account opening and maintenance work returns. These work returns occurred when Licensed Bankers opened or maintained accounts but did not collect all required information or documentation. KYC Operations reviewed the transaction, identified missing or invalid information, and sent a work return to Branch Dashboard. Branch Managers and bankers then needed to resolve the work return before customer account restrictions or closures occurred.

The stakes were high because the workflow connected employee experience, customer experience, and operational risk. If branch employees could not understand what was wrong, what action was required, or how much time remained, customers could experience repeated outreach, restricted accounts, or closed accounts.

Recommended Visual: Current branch dashboard context

Use the slide showing Branch Dashboard as a tool used to monitor controls and compliance metrics.

3. Users and Operational Workflow

The workflow involved several groups, each with different responsibilities and mental models. Customers initiated account opening or maintenance interactions. Licensed Bankers performed the work. KYC Operations reviewed documentation and created work returns when information was missing or invalid. Branch Managers and bankers were then responsible for resolution.

Primary users

- Branch Managers who monitor action items and coach employees.
- Licensed Bankers who need to understand and resolve work returns.
- Operations and compliance partners who need reliable resolution and reduced risk.

Core jobs-to-be-done

- Identify which work returns require attention.
- Understand why the issue exists and what documentation is missing.
- Prioritize work by urgency and customer impact.
- Resolve issues before restriction or closure dates.
- Track progress without relying on fragmented communication.

The existing journey created friction because the experience did not consistently match how branch employees needed to work. Employees did not just need data; they needed clear next steps, status, urgency, and confidence that the issue was moving toward resolution.

Recommended Visual: Work return lifecycle

Use the flow showing customer transaction, banker missing information, KYC Operations review, and branch resolution timelines.

4. Problem Statement

The problem could be framed from the Branch Manager perspective:

I am a Chase Branch Manager.

I am trying to help my employees resolve account opening and maintenance work returns.

So I can help them prevent customer account restrictions and closures.

But the work returns lack specific details and status updates to ensure a clear understanding of the issue and progress toward resolution.

Which results in stress and frustration for employees as they try to beat the clock before restriction or closure.

Research and journey mapping revealed three core employee problems.

Lack of clarity

The level of urgency was unclear throughout the experience, making it difficult for branch employees to know which issues to action first. Resolution instructions were also unclear, which drove support calls and slowed down remediation.

Customer frustration

When information was disorganized or instructions were incomplete, employees sometimes had to contact customers multiple times for the same missing information. Unresolved work returns could result in account restriction or closure.

Disorganized information

Accounts with multiple work returns were not always shown together in a way that supported resolution. Users needed to piece together context manually, which increased cognitive load and delayed action.

Recommended Visual: Employee problem journey map

Use the slide with lack of clarity, customer frustration, and disorganized information alongside the mapped journey.

5. My Role and Approach

As Lead Product Designer, I was responsible for connecting research, product strategy, and execution. I partnered with the quad, stakeholders, business partners, and end users throughout the double-diamond process.

Discover	Banker journeys and feedback, customer experience gaps, why-template analysis, current-state workflow review.
Define	Co-creation, feature prioritization, KPI discussions, problem framing, roadmap alignment.
Design	UI audit, system roles alignment, information architecture, release planning, high-fidelity design.
Deliver	Usability testing, UI refinement, accessibility deliverables, validation of user experience and business impact.

My goal was to move the team beyond isolated feature requests and toward a shared understanding of the full service experience: what users needed, where risk existed, where customer harm could occur, and which design interventions would create the most value.

Recommended Visual: Our approach
Use the Discover, Define, Design, Deliver slide.

6. Discovery and Research

The research strategy was iterative and mixed-methods. Qualitative research helped uncover pain points and design opportunities. Quantitative methods helped evaluate the experience, compare design directions, and measure confidence in proposed changes.

Co-creation sessions

Most research activities involved co-creation with design and content toolkits. This allowed stakeholders and users to react to tangible concepts instead of abstract requirements. It also helped reveal workflow gaps that would not have surfaced through standard feedback sessions alone.

Mixed-methods evaluation

As the design matured, I used surveys, ranking exercises, usability questions, and prototype testing to assess usability, usefulness, satisfaction, and confidence. This created a feedback loop from user journeys to high-fidelity prototype testing.

Research activities included stakeholder interviews, user interviews, journey mapping, UI audits, co-creation workshops, prioritization exercises, high-fidelity prototype testing, and accessibility reviews.

Recommended Visual: Research artifacts

Use the slides showing co-creation toolkits, mixed-methods research assets, surveys, ranking tasks, and prototype options.

7. Synthesis and Prioritization

The research did not move directly into design. Findings were translated into prioritization exercises with the quad and stakeholders so the team could align on the highest-value opportunities.

We evaluated opportunities across user value, business value, impact, urgency, and feasibility. This helped separate immediate must-haves from short-term improvements and longer-term enhancements.

The prioritization work helped ensure that roadmap decisions were not based only on stakeholder preference. They were grounded in evidence from user journeys, employee pain points, operational risk, and customer impact.

Key synthesis insight: Users did not need more data alone. They needed a clearer hierarchy of action. The experience had to show what mattered now, what could wait, and what would happen if the issue was not resolved.

Recommended Visual: Prioritization workshop

Use the feature and user prioritization matrices plus quad prioritization workshop artifacts.

8. Design Strategy

Four design principles guided the solution.

Increase urgency awareness

Users needed to immediately recognize which issues could lead to customer account restriction or closure. The redesigned experience elevated due dates, aging, unresolved status, and branch snapshot indicators.

Simplify navigation

The Action Items & Metrics page became the directory and starting point for users. Breadcrumbs created hierarchy recognition and a path back to previously visited pages. This was important because users moved between branch-level views, metric views, account work returns, and specific issue resolution pages.

Surface operational insights

The experience added trend visibility over a rolling 12-month period. Instead of only seeing a static list of issues, managers could see patterns, coach teams, monitor issue types, and prevent account restrictions and closures.

Improve resolution confidence

Clearer content, knowledge support, and resolution guidance helped reduce the need to contact support teams for every issue. The experience needed to help users answer: What happened? What do I need to do? How urgent is this? What is the current status?

9. Solution Experience

The solution redesigned the workflow around action, urgency, and resolution. Instead of treating the dashboard as a passive reporting surface, the new experience made the work actionable.

Action-oriented branch dashboard

The branch view surfaced upcoming items and a branch snapshot. Users could see incomplete items, urgency, and metrics that could result in scored errors, restrictions, closures, or upcoming due dates. This helped branch leaders prioritize action across multiple compliance tasks.

Recommended Visual: Upcoming items and branch snapshot
Use the design slide showing the Benicia branch action items and branch snapshot cards.

Simplified navigation structure

The redesigned navigation provided a clearer entry point and route through the experience. Breadcrumbs helped users understand where they were in the hierarchy and quickly return to prior pages. This was especially important in a workflow that moved from branch dashboard to metric details to account-level work returns.

Recommended Visual: Navigation and metric detail page
Use the design slide showing Action Items & Metrics, breadcrumbs, KYC trend chart, and work return table.

Real-time data visualization

Managers gained visibility into work return trends over the past 12 months. The visualization supported coaching, pattern recognition, and proactive intervention. Supporting metrics highlighted issue categories and risks such as tax-related issues and work returns that could lead to restriction or closure.

Recommended Visual: Real-time data visualization
Use the design slide emphasizing rolling 12-month trends and issue-type insights.

Guided resolution and support

The redesigned experience incorporated support content and knowledge resources closer to the point of need. This helped users find required documentation, understand resolution requirements, and reduce dependency on support calls.

10. Validation and Outcomes

The work was validated through usability testing and experience measurement. The outcomes demonstrated strong user satisfaction, perceived usability, and measurable closure of customer experience gaps.

9.5/10 UMUX-Lite score	100% CSAT score	7 CX gaps closed for metric and action items
3 High-severity CX gaps closed for the metric	Clearer Issue urgency and status visibility	Stronger Resolution confidence and coaching support

The most important design outcome was that users could more easily understand what required attention and why. The experience improved the signal-to-noise ratio of the workflow by emphasizing urgency, status, ownership, and customer impact.

The business impact extended beyond the KYC work return workflow. The broader Branch Dashboard work supported stronger compliance visibility, including a reported 90% reduction in missed audits and 98% attestation adoption. These outcomes strengthened the story that better UX can directly reduce operational risk when the experience is aligned to the way branch employees actually work.

Outcome metrics are based on project artifacts and provided portfolio notes. Validate final wording and attribution before publishing externally.

11. Reflection and Portfolio Positioning

This project reinforced that compliance experiences cannot be solved by visual redesign alone. The core design challenge was not simply making a dashboard cleaner. It was helping branch employees understand risk, prioritize action, resolve issues faster, and prevent customer harm.

The strongest part of this case study is the connection between research and measurable outcomes. The work shows a full design leadership arc: discover the operational problem, define the user and business stakes, prioritize with the quad, design the future-state workflow, validate with users, and connect the solution to business impact.

In a portfolio, this case study should be positioned as an enterprise UX and operational risk modernization project. It complements platform-focused case studies because it demonstrates depth in employee experience, compliance workflows, service design, research strategy, and data-informed product design.

Suggested page narrative: Operational Risk Problem -> Branch Employee Pain Points -> Mixed-Methods Research -> Prioritization -> Action-Oriented Dashboard -> Usability and CX Outcomes.

Appendix: Suggested Visual Placement

Section	Recommended artifact
Hero	Use the Branch Dashboard KYC Work Returns Modernization title slide or the final dashboard design.
Context	Use the Branch Dashboard monitor image and current-state screenshot.
Workflow	Use the account opening and maintenance work returns process flow.
Problem	Use the Employee Problem and How Might We slides.
Approach	Use the Discover, Define, Design, Deliver diagram.
Research	Use co-creation, mixed-methods, and prioritization workshop slides.
Solution	Use urgency dashboard, simplified navigation, and real-time visualization designs.
Outcome	Use the 9.5/10 UMUX-Lite, 100% CSAT, 7 CX gaps, and 3 high-severity gaps slide.

Recommended confidentiality edit before external use: remove company-sensitive labels, account examples, internal navigation labels, employee names, proprietary data, and any footer text that identifies internal-only materials. Recreate screens with anonymized dummy data where possible.